



TITANIUM TUTORING

How to Get Into Medicine **in Australia**

Your take-home playbook — the pathways, the UCAT, the interview, the ATAR maths, and the backup plan the top applicants actually use.

Companion guide to the seminar “How the Top 1% Get Into Medicine & Dentistry”

STUDENT GUIDE · 2026 · ADELAIDE & AUSTRALIA-WIDE

PER ASPERA AD ASTRA — THROUGH HARDSHIP, TO THE STARS



How competitive is medicine, really?

Medicine is one of Australia's hardest admissions. Understanding the numbers is the first strategic advantage.

16,950

UCAT APPLICANTS (2025)

~92nd%+

WHERE COMPETITIVE UCATS SIT

99+

TYPICAL COMPETITIVE ATAR

THE FUNNEL — ILLUSTRATED FOR ADELAIDE UNIVERSITY

Thousands apply → meet the ATAR minimum (90) & rank on the UCAT → **~600 interviewed** → **~140 offers**.
Most who clear the ATAR + UCAT bar still won't receive an offer.

MINIMUM ≠ COMPETITIVE

The website says "ATAR 90." Real offers usually need close to 99. A minimum is the door; it is not the room.

The three pillars of selection — example weighting: Adelaide University

ATAR

≈40%

Your academic rank. Gets you in the door and forms a large slice of the

UCAT

≈20%

An aptitude test. Often decides who is invited to interview at all.

Interview

≈40%

Usually an MMI. Frequently the single biggest weighted component.

APPLY TO YOUR STRENGTH

Every university splits these three pillars differently — Flinders is 90% academic with no interview; Western Sydney is 75% interview. That spread is your opportunity: target the schools that reward what you're best at.

Two doors into medicine



Both routes lead to the same MD and the same medical registration. Pick the one that fits where you are now.

	Undergraduate / direct entry	Graduate entry
When you apply	From Year 12 (school leaver)	After finishing a bachelor degree
Admissions test	UCAT ANZ (sat in Year 12)	GAMSAT
Also assessed	ATAR + interview (usually MMI)	GPA + interview
Degree length	5–7 yrs combined (e.g. BMedSt → MD)	4-year MD (after a 3-yr degree)
Years to doctor	~6 years + internship	~3 + 4 years + internship
SA examples	Adelaide, Flinders (BClinSci → MD)	Flinders MD + interstate MDs
Best if...	You're strong now and ready to commit	You want another degree first, or missed direct entry

INSIDER TIP

Missing direct entry is not the end — graduate entry keeps the door open for years. Many excellent doctors took exactly that route. Your backup is a plan, not a failure plan (see page 11).

The whole national landscape at a glance — **direct-entry programs by state**

The next page is the one to photograph. Rows are grouped by state, with South Australia first. "Hurdle" means the ATAR only has to clear a bar — it isn't scored beyond that.

Direct-entry medicine, Australia-wide



University	Pathway	ATAR	UCAT	Interview	Prerequisites
SOUTH AUSTRALIA					
Adelaide University	BMedSt/MD · 6yr	90+ (40%)	20%	40%	1 of Bio / Chem / Methods
Flinders University	BClinSci/MD · 6yr	95+ (90%)	10%	—	None
VICTORIA					
Monash University	BMedSc/MD · 5yr	90+ (~1/3)	~1/3	~1/3	Chemistry + English
NEW SOUTH WALES / ACT					
UNSW Sydney	BMed/MD · 6yr	96+	Yes (~1/3)	Yes (~1/3)	—
Newcastle / New England (JMP)	BMedSc/MD · 5yr	Hurdle 94.3+	Ranks	Yes (+PQA)	—
Western Sydney / Charles Sturt	BClinSci/MD · 5yr	95.5+ (hurdle)	25%	75%	—
University of Sydney	BSc/BA + MD · 7yr	99.95	—	100%	—
QUEENSLAND					
University of Queensland	Provisional MD · 6yr	95+	Yes	—	English + Maths Methods
James Cook University	MBBS · 6yr	~95 (rural focus)	—	Yes	Eng + Methods + Chem
Bond University	BMedSt/MD · 4yr 8mo	96+ (hurdle)	—	100%	English
Griffith / UniSC	BMedSc → MD	99.90+	Tie-break	—	None formal
WESTERN AUSTRALIA					
University of WA	BBiomed → MD · 6yr	98+ (30%)	20%	50%	None formal
Curtin University	MBBS · 5yr	95+ (40%)	20%	40% (+CASPer)	Chemistry
TASMANIA · NORTHERN TERRITORY					
University of Tasmania	BMedSci/MD · 5yr	95+ (primary)	Secondary	—	English + Chemistry
Charles Darwin University	BClinSci → NTMP · 6yr	90+ (NT quotas)	10%	—	None

Weightings and cut-offs change every cycle and some schools don't publish exact splits. Always verify on each university's official admissions page before you rely on a number. Interactive version: the Selection Score Decoder (page 13).



South Australia spotlight

Adelaide University — Bachelor of Medical Studies & Doctor of Medicine (BMedSt/MD)

DURATION

6 years, single intake, ~136 domestic places

APPLY VIA

SATAC + sit the UCAT in Year 12

MINIMUM ATAR

90 (competitive far higher)

SELECTION

UCAT 20% · Interview 40% · Academic 40%

INTERVIEW

MMI, invited on UCAT ranking

PREREQUISITE

One of Biology, Chemistry or Maths Methods

THE TWO-STAGE REALITY

Clear ATAR 90, and your **UCAT alone** ranks you for an interview. Only at the final offer does it become 40% academic / 20% UCAT / 40% interview. Your UCAT gets you in the room; your interview and ATAR win the seat.

Flinders University — two ways in

Direct entry (school leaver)

Bachelor of Clinical Sciences → MD. Academic-dominant: **90% ATAR, 10% UCAT, no interview**. Progress to the MD by maintaining GPA. A strong option if interviews aren't your strength.

Graduate entry

Finish a bachelor, sit the GAMSAT, then the 4-year MD. Flinders reserves many graduate places for its own science graduates.

Selection rank & adjustment factors

Equity Scheme — *applies to medicine*

Up to **5 points** on your selection rank for equity, low-SES, remote schooling or individual disadvantage. Often automatic for eligible SA students — and underclaimed.

Subject bonus — *NOT for medicine*

SATAC's Language, Literacy & Maths bonus is **excluded** from the Adelaide & Flinders medicine programs. Don't pick a subject just for a medicine bonus — it won't count.

INSIDER TIP

Check your equity eligibility on SATAC early. These adjustments are real, automatic for many SA students, and frequently missed.



Selection rank, decoded

MINIMUM ATAR

90+ generally

The floor — enough to be looked at.

COMPETITIVE ATAR

99+ generally

Where offers actually sit.

SELECTION RANK

ATAR + adjustments

What universities actually rank you on.

Building the perfect subject stack

Subject	Why it earns its place
Specialist Maths	Elite scaling — lifts your ATAR the most.
Mathematical Methods	Strong scaling + a prerequisite at several schools.
Chemistry	Strong scaling + a prerequisite at several schools.
English	A prerequisite at many universities — don't skip it.
Extension / Headstart studies	The cheat code — a High Distinction can convert to 20/20.
Your choice (e.g. Biology)	Play to genuine interest and a manageable workload.

DO THIS IN YEAR 10

Choose subjects you can genuinely **ace** — a top mark in a well-scaling subject beats a middling mark in a “prestigious” one. Confirm each target university's prerequisites before you lock in.

COMMON TRAP

A high ATAR alone guarantees nothing. Without a strong UCAT and interview, even 99+ can miss. Treat all three pillars as one project.



A skill test, not a content test

A ~2-hour computer test of reasoning under time pressure, sat in Year 12. Since 2025 it has four sections.

Section	What it tests	Format	Pace
Verbal Reasoning	Read fast, reason only from the text	44 Q · 22 min	~30s / Q
Decision Making	Logic, syllogisms, probability	35 Q · 37 min	~63s / Q
Quantitative Reasoning	Quick applied maths on data	36 Q · 26 min	~43s / Q
Situational Judgement	Ethics & professionalism	Banded 1–4	tie-breaker

The three cognitive sections score ~900–2700 combined; Situational Judgement is banded separately. **The score to beat keeps rising** — the 90th-percentile total has climbed ~180 points since 2020.

Trainable, but not crammable — a 6–8 month arc

Yr 10–11	Awareness	Know what UCAT is. Try a few official questions. Build reading speed & mental maths quietly.
Late Yr 11	Foundations	Learn each section's question types. Practise untimed first — accuracy before speed.
~3–4 mo out	Build	Timed sets, then full mocks. Review every mistake in an error log. Layer in speed.
Final 2 wks	Sharpen	Light mocks, lock in your test-day routine. Protect sleep.

High-yield habits

- ☐ Master question types before timing yourself
- ☐ Keep an error log — understanding why beats raw volume
- ☐ Add the timer only once the method is solid
- ☐ Use free official UCAT ANZ tests before paying
- ☐ Practise on a keyboard & on-screen calculator

Mistakes that cost places

- ☐ Drilling without learning the strategies
- ☐ Leaving UCAT to the final four weeks
- ☐ Skipping regular timed mocks
- ☐ Treating every subtest the same
- ☐ Neglecting sleep and wellbeing



Scan to download

Free UCAT Error Log

The habit that reliably lifts a score: log every mistake, tag the cause, review weekly, and fix the *pattern* — not the single question.

titaniumtutoring.com.au/downloads/UCAT-Error-Log-Titanium-Tutoring.xlsx



What the MMI really assesses

Most schools use a Multiple Mini Interview: a circuit of short stations, each scoring a different quality. There's rarely a "right answer" — assessors score *how you think and communicate*.

Common station types

- ☐ Ethical scenario (a dilemma, no clean answer)
- ☐ Role-play / communication (with an actor)
- ☐ Personal & motivation ("why medicine?")
- ☐ Teamwork or problem-solving task
- ☐ Reflection on an experience

A structure that breathes

Pause — breathe, think before talking.
Signpost — "There are two sides here..."
Both sides — weigh them honestly.
Example — ground it in something real.
Land it — a clear, considered position.

Situational & ethical stations — how to work the question

- ☐ **Be structured and systematic** — signpost so the assessor can follow your reasoning.
- ☐ **Identify your role** — who are you here, and what are you responsible for?
- ☐ **Know your limits** — your capacity, boundaries and what you can safely do.
- ☐ **Identify the problems** — name every issue, not just the obvious one.
- ☐ **Weigh the importance of each action** — safety, people, outcomes.
- ☐ **Prioritise by urgency** — then act, methodically.

DON'T

Recite a memorised script — it always sounds memorised. Practise **out loud with a real person**; structure over scripts.

Scan to open



Free MMI Simulator

Sit a timed interview station — reading clock, answer clock — then see the assessor rubric: exactly what they score, and a strong structure to follow.

titaniumtutoring.com.au/resources/mmi-simulator



Your year-by-year action plan

Year 10

- ☐ Choose subjects you can ACE
- ☐ Learn what the UCAT is
- ☐ Build reading + mental-maths habits
- ☐ Try real volunteering / exposure
- ☐ Confirm prerequisites for your shortlist

Year 11

- ☐ Keep marks consistent & high
- ☐ Lay UCAT foundations (light)
- ☐ Research universities & weightings
- ☐ Check rural / equity eligibility
- ☐ Start reflecting on "why medicine"

Year 12

- ☐ Serious UCAT prep, then sit it
- ☐ Maximise your ATAR
- ☐ Lodge SATAC + interstate apps
- ☐ Prepare for the MMI out loud
- ☐ Set preferences + a real backup

Hidden advantages worth checking early

Rural background pathways

Reserved quotas at many universities (Adelaide reserves places for rural students). Eligibility is about where you've lived or studied — gather evidence (addresses, dates) well in advance. Often a genuinely less-contested route to the same degree.

Bonded medical places

In return for a place, you agree to work a period in an area of workforce need after graduating. It can widen access — but understand the obligation before you accept.



The 2026 cycle (for 2027 entry)

Mar	UCAT booking opens	Register early on the UCAT ANZ site.
May	Booking closes	Booking deadline is mid-May — miss it, miss the year.
Jul–Aug	Sit the UCAT	Test window; results issued shortly after.
~30 Sep	Applications close	SATAC & interstate medicine deadlines (earlier than general uni offers).
Nov–Dec	Interviews	Invitations based on UCAT / ATAR; MMIs run.
Dec–Jan	Offers	ATAR released, then offer rounds.

Dates follow recent cycles — confirm exact 2026 dates on UCAT ANZ and SATAC, as they shift slightly each year.

Traps that catch good students

DEADLINE TRAP

Medicine deadlines differ from general uni offers, and UCAT booking closes months earlier.

DOCUMENTATION TRAP

Equity / rural evidence missing or late. Gather proof early.

OVERCONFIDENCE TRAP

A high ATAR alone guarantees nothing without UCAT + interview.

SINGLE-APPLICATION TRAP

Pinning everything on one university, or one pillar.



If you miss direct entry

A backup is a plan, not a failure. Most graduate-entry doctors took exactly this route.

Results day → what next

01 · UCAT-focused gap

ATAR 98+ · UCAT weak. Take a planned gap year and rebuild the UCAT properly — the ATAR already clears the bar. (UCAT is only valid one year.)

02 · Repeat & re-sit

ATAR 95+ · UCAT weak. Gap year: repeat a few Year 12 subjects and re-sit the UCAT — lift both pillars and re-rank higher.

03 · Launchpad degree

ATAR <95. Enter a related field (allied health, paramedicine), keep a strong GPA, and target graduate entry via GAMSAT.

The graduate route is real

Do a degree you'd enjoy → keep a strong GPA → sit the GAMSAT → apply to a 4-year MD. The interview still matters — same skills as today. Options include **Flinders, Melbourne, Deakin, UQ, ANU** and more.

MYTH

"Biomed guarantees medicine." It doesn't — it's a fine base, but still needs GPA + GAMSAT + interview. Choose a degree you'd be happy to keep.

A gap year — when it's smart

Smart when... your ATAR was strong but UCAT let you down; you'll lift one weak pillar with focus; you'll broaden applications interstate; you'll use the year well (work, volunteering, real experience).

Think twice when... it's just to avoid deciding; you won't actually change what went wrong; you'd lose momentum with no clear goal.

Less-known moves — verify current rules on each university's site

Course transfer

Hard, and few universities offer it. **Flinders does not** allow it. Adelaide allows transfer after one year with a very high GPA — but it's fiercely competitive, you still sit UCAT + interview, and you start in first year.

Launchpad: optometry (Flinders)

Bachelor of Medical Science + Master of Optometry. Sit the GAMSAT and keep a high GPA (~6.5/7) to aim for graduate medicine. Note: you only qualify as an optometrist if you **finish the optometry masters** — so it's a genuine choice, not both at once.

Myth vs reality

**MYTH**

"A 90 ATAR is enough."

REALITY

90 is a minimum; offers often need ~99.

MYTH

"UCAT is an IQ test you can't study for."

REALITY

It's a skill test, trainable over months.

MYTH

"Biomed guarantees medicine."

REALITY

It guarantees nothing; still GPA + GAMSAT + interview.

MYTH

"Year 12 entry is the only way."

REALITY

Graduate entry keeps the door open for years.

MYTH

"Just apply to the local uni."

REALITY

Apply wide & interstate, matched to your strengths.

MYTH

"A high ATAR wins."

REALITY

The UCAT and interview usually decide it.

THE ONE IDEA TO KEEP

Medicine entry rewards **strategy**, not just intelligence. Know the weightings, apply to your strengths, prepare all three pillars early, and always have a real backup. That's what the top applicants do differently.



Tools, links & your next 7 days

Free student tools — scan and start tonight

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Selection Score Decoder

See how your ATAR, UCAT & interview combine into a rank across 15 programs — and where you're genuinely competitive.

</resources/selection-score-decoder>

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MMI Simulator

A timed interview station plus the assessor rubric — what they score and how to structure a strong answer.

</resources/mmi-simulator>

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UCAT Error Log

The review habit that moves scores: log every mistake, find the pattern, fix it.

</downloads/UCAT-Error-Log...xlsx>

Scan to register



Need 1:1 assistance?

Personalised UCAT, interview & application strategy around your timeline. Register your interest.

</contact>

Bookmark the official sources



UCAT ANZ

Register, key dates & free official practice tests.

ucat.edu.au



SATAC

SA / NT applications & adjustment factors.

satac.edu.au

Do this now — your next 7 days

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Find your year on the action plan (page 9) | ☐ Run your profile through the Selection Score Decoder |
| ☐ Confirm prerequisites for your target universities | ☐ Start a UCAT error log on your next practice set |
| ☐ Bookmark UCAT ANZ, SATAC & your top admissions pages | ☐ Book one honest chat with a careers counsellor |

Per aspera ad astra — through hardship, to the stars.

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